



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Academy of Classical Christian Studies

School Website: <https://theacademyok.org/>

December 21, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix for more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

The Academy of Classical Christian Studies (OKC) serving 73131 demonstrates a robust classical-Christian orientation across the six classical criteria. Public-facing materials emphasize Truth, Goodness, and Beauty as trans-cendent aims; theology is integrated into the educational program (Nicene Creed anchoring identity); liturgical rhythm and prayer ground daily life; the curriculum centers on the Trivium (grammar, dialectic, rhetoric) and the Great Books/Great Conversation through an integrated, imitative, and formation-focused model; pedagogy blends contemplative/restful elements with Socratic-discussion dynamics in upper grades; the faculty are presented as mentors and living embodiments of the school's ideals; and parents are positioned as co-educators and partners in a transdenominational Christian community. Evidence across multiple pages (mission, theology, liturgical practice, the Trivium, Lyceum, Capstone, faculty leadership, and parental partnership) strongly supports CLASSICAL classification across all six categories. Notable textual anchors include the mission to cultivate Truth, Goodness, and Beauty; the Nicene Creed statement of faith; daily prayer and liturgical rhythm; explicit Trivium framing and pedagogy; a public portrait of a graduate oriented to forming affections toward the True, the Good, and the Beautiful; and explicit parental partnership through structures like the Giving Society and family-engagement programming. See source references to mission statements, theology, liturgical practice, Trivium, Lyceum, Capstone, and parent-community collaboration.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - Mission explicitly centers Truth, Goodness, and Beauty as affections to be shaped, for the glory of Jesus Christ.
 - Statement of Faith anchors unity in the Nicene Creed, signaling explicit theological grounding.
 - The public materials describe liturgical rhythms, communal prayer, and the Church calendar as shaping education, including reference to praying the Hours (lex orandi).
 - Transdenominational stance positions the school within a shared Christian/theological frame rather than a single denomination, while maintaining a theologically anchored education.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords present (category 1): truth, goodness, beauty; virtue; theology; liturgy; prayer; sacred tradition; Logos; reverence; wonder; communal worship. The Academy's materials repeatedly cite Truth, Goodness, Beauty and the Nicene Creed, plus liturgical/prayer practices. Estimated presence: high (roughly 8–12 clearly positive category-1 keywords identified in public materials).
 - Negative keywords present: effectively none in public-facing texts (no clear signaling of secularism, relativism, or morality-neutral language in mission/theology sections). Estimated presence: very low to zero.
- Why this rating

-
- The school explicitly grounds education in transcendent realities and Christian theological commitments, with liturgical practice and communal worship integrated into school life. The explicit Nicene Creed and the language around Truth, Goodness, and Beauty align squarely with the classical model's religious/metaphysical foundations. The absence of values-neutral or secular signals reinforces CLASSICAL status.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - The Portrait of a Graduate centers forming whole persons who seek True, Good, and Beautiful and emphasizes formation over mere information.
 - Mission and program language highlight formation of affections for Truth, Goodness, and Beauty rather than vocational precursors alone; formation is tied to a Christian worldview.
 - The school articulates a purposeful aim beyond mere content delivery, including contemplative and memory-focused elements consistent with scholé and the classical telos.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords present: formation; virtue/wisdom; true/good/beautiful; contemplation/scholé; teleology (implied by telos toward virtue); mentorship; living books; cultural formation. Estimated presence: high (roughly 6–10 category-2 positive keywords).
 - Negative keywords present: virtually none (no emphasis on job-prep, career metrics, or secular/non-formation goals). Estimated presence: near-zero.
- Why this rating
 - The school explicitly defines education as formation oriented toward virtue and wisdom rather than solely information transfer or job-prep metrics. The language around the True, Good, Beautiful, and the formation of affections aligns with classical paideia aims rather than a purely utilitarian or secular frame.

Element 3: Curriculum — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - The Trivium is foregrounded: grammar (PK3–5th), dialectic (6th–8th), rhetoric (9th–12th). This explicit “Trivium” framing appears repeatedly in curriculum materials.
 - The curriculum emphasizes the Great Books/Great Conversation through interdisciplinary integration (e.g., Omnibus course blending history and literature).
 - Capstone, Lyceum, and traditional liberal-arts framing demonstrate a coherent, integrated classical curriculum (grammar, dialectic, rhetoric; history-laden core; emphasis on contemplation and wonder).
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords present: Seven Liberal Arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric); Great Books; Great Conversation; integration of history/literature; wonder; classical canon; imitation/formation through literature and exemplars. Estimated presence: high (7–12 category-3 keywords).
 - Negative keywords present: minimal to none (no heavy emphasis on social studies as replacement for history; no overt “project-based-only” framing). Estimated presence: low.
- Why this rating
 - The public-facing curricular materials map strongly onto the classical curriculum model: Trivium, Great Books, integrated history-literature, and formation through exposure to canonical texts and exemplars. The presence of Capstone and Lyceum supports a coherent classical-formation approach.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - Lower-level practices include contemplative/restful learning (Scholé) and a memory/timing rhythm, evidenced by liturgical/prayer rhythms and reflective pedagogy embedded in Lyceum

-
- days and hours.
 - Upper-level pedagogy emphasizes Socratic-style inquiry, seminars, and rhetorical training (Rhetoric stage; Capstone; public speaking opportunities). The Trivium framing implies dialectic/seminar-style exploration in higher grades; capstone projects emphasize argument and public defense.
 - The Lyceum and outside-speaker engagement illustrate an integrated, formation-focused pedagogy that bridges classroom content with wider cultural engagement.
 - Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords present: Socratic dialogue; dialectic; seminars; rhetoric; chant/narration/memorization; contemplative learning; restfulness; memory/recitation; formation through practice; living books; great conversation. Estimated presence: high (approximately 7–12 category-4 keywords).
 - Negative keywords present: little to none (no dominant reliance on purely project-based, skills-first, or purely constructivist approaches in the public-facing materials). Estimated presence: low.
 - Why this rating
 - The school clearly deploys a dual-pathed pedagogy: contemplative/restful elements (Scholé) paired with Socratic/seminar-based inquiry and rhetoric training; a strong emphasis on memorization/recitation in the lower/middle grades and rigorous rhetoric in the upper grades. This aligns with classical pedagogy expectations.

Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - Public materials present a clear “leadership and faculty” structure, with named Headmaster and faculty profiles; the faculty are described as living curriculum and mentors (e.g., Headmaster Nathan Carr; Associate Headmaster Stephen Taylor; Grammar/Dialectic/Rhetoric principals; Fine Arts staff).
 - Governing/leadership bodies (Board of Governors) and staff directories demonstrate a living curriculum culture and a portrait of the teacher they expect.
 - The school emphasizes teacher-student mentorship and a “portrait of a teacher/student” ethos, including faculty responsibilities and stone-cold alignment with mission.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords present: living curriculum; mentors; teacher as exemplar; portrait of a teacher; staff leadership; community of scholars; board governance; faculty as core of the school. Estimated presence: high (6–10 category-5 keywords).
 - Negative keywords present: minimal signals of purely technocratic or non-classical faculty models.
- Why this rating
 - The public materials present a cohesive, mentor-driven faculty culture aligned with classical education norms (faculty as the living curriculum, strong mentorship, and recognizable leadership).

Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - The Academy positions itself as transdenominational and explicitly engages families as co-educators; parent partnership is a central motif (e.g., “transdenominational,” parent engagement; view events; admissions).
 - There are structured opportunities for parent involvement (View Events pages; Campus tours; Giving Society; parent training materials; book groups). The Giving Society details show a formal path for parental/guardian engagement and philanthropy.
 - Open invitation to campus visits and ongoing parent engagement are evident in event pages and admissions materials.

-
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords present: partnership with families; parent formation; parent-co-teachers; family engagement; community of learners; open campus; parent visibility; liturgical/year events; sacred/Christian worldview in family life. Estimated presence: high (6–10 category-6 keywords).
 - Negative keywords present: minimal signals of consumer-focused or restricted parent access; no “customer” framing found in public materials.
 - Why this rating
 - The school places parents as co-educators and actively engages them through events, book groups, and a Giving Society, consistent with classical-community formation models.

aggregate ranking: CLASSICAL

Overall, the six categories align with CLASSICAL with strong alignment to the core classical lexicon and practices (Truth-Goodness-Beauty; Trivium; Great Books/Great Conversation; Scholé; Cicero-style rhetoric and capstone-type public speaking; mentors and living curriculum; parent partnership and communal religious life).

What Would Move the Needle - Not applicable here since the aggregate classification is CLASSICAL across all six categories. No category requires needle-moving changes to achieve CLASSICAL status; the school already demonstrates a coherent classical framework across all six dimensions.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

By reading or using this document, you acknowledge and accept the limitations described above.